

Adware or Ad ware

This is software that downloads and displays advertisements. This kind of software is often bundled with Freeware.

Alias

There is no standard, accepted rule for naming viruses. Hence, even though informal groups, such as CARO, have discussed conventions for virus naming, differences still exist between antivirus software companies and research organisations. Thus, where the term 'alias' or 'also known as' occurs, it refers to different names that the same virus may have been given by other sources.

Annoyance

Any trojan that does not cause any major damage, but instead annoys a user by turning the text on the screen upside down, or making mouse motions erratic, and so on.

ANSI Bomb

Character sequences that reprogram specific keys on the keyboard. If ANSI.SYS is loaded, some bombs will display colourful messages, or have interesting (but unwanted) graphical effects.

Anti-emulation

To reliably detect polymorphic viruses, scanners include code emulators to simulate the running of executable code and check whether it decrypts to a known virus. An emulator must stop emulating a program once it is no longer necessary, and for performance reasons many emulators have simple rules for quickly determining a stopping point. Some polymorphic viruses include tricks attempting to defeat these code emulators by fooling them into quitting the emulation before the decryption code has finished its work. Such methods are commonly called anti-emulation techniques.

Antivirus Virus

The idea of making an antivirus program viral so that it can propagate to where it is most needed is a very old one. Such a program would be an antivirus virus. It is universally agreed among rep-